

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1990-11-21

To the friends gathered at the moscow conference

1 dear bahá'í friends,

2 it is with a sense of joy and wonderment that we address you, the rep-

resentatives of the bahá'í communities throughout the uSSr and of the

3 National Spiritual Assemblies which have been given the awesome respon-

4 sibility for raising up the cause of bahá'u'lláh in that vast area. The march

5 of world events has utterly transformed the scene of your labors, presenting 98.1

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101 179you with formidable problems but with achievements and opportunities

102 which must cause your hearts to sing with joy to the Almighty.

103 in the heroic Age of the faith many events occurred to link it with the

104 peoples of russia. we need but mention the offer of asylum extended to

105 bahá'u'lláh by the russian government prior to his banishment to iraq;

106 his Tablet addressed to Tsar Alexander ii; the deep interest that the cause

107 aroused in russian scholars and leading literary figures; the glories of the

108 bahá'í community which arose in 'i shqábád; the exemplary action of the

109 members of that community in appealing for clemency for its persecutors; and the
raising of the first mashriqu'l-A dhkár in that city. A beginning

110 which showed such promise was eclipsed by the restrictions following the first world
war but, even in those dark days, the beloved guardian saw

111 clearly that it was but a temporary veiling of the light of this revelation. in

112 a letter he wrote in persian to the believers in 'i shqábád on 11 january 1923

113 we find these insightful words:

There is no doubt that the day will come when the very people who

are now engaged in destroying the foundations of faith in god and

114 promoting this baseless doctrine of materialism will arise and, by their

115 own hand, snuff out the flame of this commotion. They will sweep away the entire
structure of their unrestrained godlessness and will

116 arise with heart and soul, and with hitherto unmatched vigor, to atone

117 for their past failures. They will join the ranks of the followers of bahá'u'lláh and arise
to promote his cause. . . . if the friends remain

118 steadfast, and discharge their duties with loyalty and prudence, the veils of god's
inscrutable wisdom will be lifted and extraordinary

119 events will be witnessed. The hosts of divine confirmation, fortified by the power of
the Spirit will, in unimaginable ways and from unex-

pected quarters, provide the means for the triumph of the cause of

120 our Self-Subsisting lord, and in so doing will brighten the eyes of the

121 faithful throughout the world.

122 And again, on 2 j anuary 1930:

123 russia will in the future become a delectable paradise, and the teach-

124 ing work in that land will be carried out on an unprecedented scale.

The house of worship established in its very heart will shine forth

with dazzling splendor, and the call of the most great Name will 99.2

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100 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

101 180reverberate in its temples, its churches, and its places of worship. we

need to show forth patience and forbearance. in these momentous

102 convulsions there lie concealed mighty and consummate mysteries,

103 which will be revealed to men's eyes in the days to come.

we have been blessed to see the beginning of the unfoldment of these

104 mysteries, and to this generation has been entrusted the task of conveying

105 the message of bahá'u'lláh to the many races and peoples of that land, and

106 of raising up b ahá'í communities in its cities, towns and villages.

The society in the midst of which you are called upon to work is un-

107 dergoing radical changes in every aspect of its life, changes which are but a
concentration of the problems with which every country, and world society as a whole, is
grappling. The underlying cause of this transformation is

108 that this is the age of the oneness of mankind, and therefore every people,
109 whether of the uSSr or in other parts of the world, must find its way to
110 the unity in diversity, the harmony of formerly conflicting elements, which
111 Shoghi effendi held forth as the goal towards which mankind is striving. on
112 this theme he wrote on 11 march 1936 to the emerging bahá'í communities
113 of the west, directing their attention to the challenging statements made by
114 the f ounder of their f aith:

115 "A new life," bahá'u'lláh proclaims, "is, in this age, stirring within
116 all the peoples of the earth; and yet none hath discovered its cause, or perceived its
motive." "o ye children of men," he thus addresses his

generation, "the fundamental purpose animating the faith of god

117 and his religion is to safeguard the interests and promote the unity of
118 the human race . . . This is the straight path, the fixed and immovable foundation.
whatsoever is raised on this foundation, the changes and
119 chances of the world can never impair its strength, nor will the revolu-tion of
countless centuries undermine its structure." "The well-being of mankind," he declares, "its
peace and security are unattainable un-

120 less and until its unity is firmly established." "So powerful is the light
121 of unity," is his further testimony, "that it can illuminate the whole

earth. The one true god, he who knoweth all things, himself testifi-

122 eth to the truth of these words . . . This goal excelleth every other goal, and this
aspiration is the monarch of all aspirations." "h e who is your

123 lord, the All-m erciful," he, moreover, has written, "cherisheth in his
124 heart the desire of beholding the entire human race as one soul and 99.3

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100 1986–1992 • T h e S i x Y e a r P l a n

101 181one body. haste ye to win your share of god's good grace and mercy

in this d ay that eclipseth all other created days."99-1

commenting on the implications of these momentous words, Shoghi

102 effendi states:

The unity of the human race, as envisaged by bahá'u'lláh, implies

103 the establishment of a world commonwealth in which all nations,

races, creeds and classes are closely and permanently united, and in

which the autonomy of its state members and the personal freedom

104 and initiative of the individuals that compose them are definitely and completely safeguarded. . . .

A world federal system, ruling the whole earth and exercising un-

105 challengeable authority over its unimaginably vast resources, blending and embodying the ideals of both the east and the west, liberated

from the curse of war and its miseries, and bent on the exploitation

106 of all the available sources of energy on the surface of the planet, a

107 system in which force is made the servant of justice, whose life is sus-

108 tained by its universal recognition of one god and by its allegiance to

109 one common revelation—such is the goal towards which humanity,

110 impelled by the unifying forces of life, is moving.

111 99-2

112 No one who contemplates the present conditions of the world, let alone

of the uSSr, could expect that such a consummation will come without

113 great effort, without traversing manifold difficulties. but the mainspring of

114 its achievement is the awakening of ever more human beings to the truth of the message of bahá'u'lláh, and their adherence to his cause and his

115 covenant, the illumination of their spiritual and moral lives by the light

116 of his Teachings, and the unification of their efforts through his Admin-

117 istrative order. Through their individual transformation and through their

118 combined efforts they will transform the conditions of the world and bring

119 to birth a new, worldwide civilization.

120 The culmination of this process lies in centuries ahead, but it is not in the

121 end alone that joy is found. The true nature of the human soul is spiritual; it is the relationship of each soul to god and its kinship with every other

122 99-1. wob, p. 202.

123 99-2. wob, pp. 203, 204.99.4b

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100 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

101 182soul that brings true happiness and fulfillment. our bahá'í communities are

102 still far from the perfection that bahá'u'lláh desires for us, but it is in our

103 loving support of one another, in our forbearance of each other's failings, in

104 our determination to develop and uphold the institutions which bahá'u'lláh

105 has ordained, in our spirit of love and of tolerance towards all people, and in our courage and perseverance through all difficulties, that we achieve the

106 fulfillment of our lives.

107 Now, at this conference, you are to consider the conditions of the cause

108 in your lands, to examine the possibilities before you and to recommend the

109 courses of action that you deem to be most advantageous in the months im-

110 mediately ahead. There are tasks to which you must now set your hands to

111 prepare for the achievements of tomorrow. do not permit the problems in

112 your way to dismay you or deflect you from your goals; it is to overcome the

problems of humankind that the bahá'í community has been brought into

113 being. your vital task is to immerse yourselves in the study of the Teachings

114 of bahá'u'lláh, to enrich your spiritual lives and to discover thereby the

115 best direction for your endeavors, to express them in your actions, and to convey them to those who thirst for guidance. you are the instruments of

116 the purpose of god, the channels of his grace, the bearers of his message,

117 the holders of the key to the challenges of the age. follow his guidance and

118 the successes you will achieve will be an inspiration to your fellow-believers and the quickener of hope in the hearts of the people.

119 be assured that as you arise for the promotion of his cause, the confir-

120 mations of bahá'u'lláh will surround you, and you will witness the truth of

121 these exalted words uttered by him in his most glorious presence:

verily, we behold you from our realm of glory, and shall aid who-

soever will arise for the triumph of our cause with the hosts of the

122 concourse on high and a company of our favored angels.

123 99-3

we shall pray ardently on your behalf in the holy Shrines and eagerly

124 await news of the outcome of your deliberations.

125 with loving b áhá'í greetings,

126 99-3. kA, ¶53.99.7

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Suspension of Pilgrimage Program

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]